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BRUSH WITH DEATH

This was a rather difficult year for me. I have had to confront the brutality of police officers, an unwarranted arrest, and a near fatal stab wound by a mentally deranged woman. These things were poured upon me like staggering torrents on a cold, wintry day.

SEPTEMBER 3, 1958
King is arrested in Montgomery

SEPTEMBER 4
After his conviction for failing to obey an officer, King's fine is paid by Montgomery police commissioner

SEPTEMBER 20
Is stabbed in Harlem

OCTOBER 3
After release from Harlem Hospital, begins convalescing at the home of the Reverend Sandy F. Ray

OCTOBER 24
Returns to Montgomery to continue recuperation

On a Saturday afternoon in 1958, I sat in a Harlem department store, surrounded by hundreds of people. I was autographing copies of *Stride Toward Freedom*, my book about the Montgomery bus boycott. And while sitting there, a demented black woman came up. The only question I heard from her was, "Are you Martin Luther King?"

I was looking down writing, and I said "Yes." And the next minute, I felt something sharp plunge forcefully into my chest. Before I knew it, I had been stabbed with a letter opener by a woman who would later be judged insane, Mrs. Izola Ware Curry.

Rushed by ambulance to Harlem Hospital, I lay in a bed for hours while preparations were made to remove the keen-edged knife from my body. Days later, when I was well enough to talk with Dr. Aubrey Maynard, the